Nexura: building on a licensed partner (Option 2)

Prepared for the Nexura team, 13 October 2026

Nexura's wallet uses a phone's secure hardware to sign stablecoin transfers between African mobile money networks, starting with M-Pesa Kenya to MTN Nigeria. This document explains the licensed-partner model: Nexura owns the product and the signing key, and a regulated partner owns the regulated money movements. It is a planning aid, not legal advice, and a Kenyan fintech lawyer should confirm the structure before launch.

Who does what

	Nexura	Licensed partner	Mobile money operators
App, UX, brand	Yes		
Hardware-backed wallet and signing	Yes		
Collecting KES from M-Pesa	Triggers it	Runs the collection	Moves the money
Converting fiat to and from stablecoin		Yes	
Paying out NGN to MTN	Triggers it	Runs the payout	Moves the money
Holding fiat float		Yes	
Licences and regulator relationship	Limited	Yes	Yes
Customer support	Yes, first line	Escalations	

The principle: Nexura owns the product and the key, and the partner owns the regulated money movements.

How this looks with real partner APIs

Both candidates checked are API-first and offer a sandbox, so building can start before any contract is signed.

Kotani Pay

- Connects apps to M-PESA, MTN, Airtel and Orange money, bank transfers and blockchain networks.
- Supports deposits and withdrawals, plus an onramp (fiat in, crypto delivered to a wallet address) and an offramp (crypto in, fiat paid out via mobile money or bank transfer).
- A deposit works as an STK push on M-PESA, where the customer approves with their PIN, and webhooks notify your server when the transaction settles.
- Integration starts with an integrator account and sandbox testing before going live.

Yellow Card

- Offers a stablecoin-powered API for businesses to integrate local fiat on/off-ramps, with MTN Mobile Money as a supported channel.
- Businesses must complete KYB onboarding by submitting company documents before going live.
- API requests are accepted only from whitelisted IP addresses. This matters for a Cloudflare Workers backend, so check how static egress IPs work there.

To confirm

Neither partner's coverage of the Kenya to Nigeria corridor has been confirmed, nor whether either accepts a startup as a white-label integrator. These are the first questions to ask.

Where the wallet fits

The lightest-touch model:

1. A Kenyan user pays KES from M-Pesa. The partner collects it and delivers stablecoin straight to the user's own smart account, controlled by their phone's secure chip.
2. To send, the user's chip signs a transfer of stablecoin to the partner's offramp address.
3. The partner pays out NGN to the recipient's MTN wallet.

Nexura never holds funds, and the partner touches them only in transit. This is the non-custodial route, and the wallet design supports it. It changes the original flow, where deposits land in an app balance, so ask the lawyer whether this version improves Nexura's regulatory position. That is the main reason to build it this way.

What partners will ask of you

- Company registration documents and ownership details.
- A description of the product, expected volumes and corridors.
- Your KYC and fraud approach. Find out whether the partner KYCs your end users or Nexura must, since that shapes the onboarding flow.
- A security overview, which is the hardware-signing story.
- Often a minimum volume, a deposit, or a pre-funded balance. For reference, MTN's own disbursement product expects a partner to open an account and pre-fund it. Partner models exist partly so Nexura does not carry that float.

Terms to negotiate

- Fees, FX spread and revenue share. The demo's 0.20% route fee is a placeholder, and real partner costs are likely higher.
- Limits per transaction, per day and per user, since these cap growth.
- Ownership of customer data and the user relationship.
- Refunds, failed payouts and disputes: who bears the cost and how fast they resolve.
- Settlement times and uptime commitments.
- What happens if regulation changes or either side exits, including a notice period and a way to move users.
- No exclusivity, so a second partner can be added.

What to build now

- A provider abstraction layer, so Kotani Pay, Yellow Card or any other partner plugs in behind one interface. The existing `api.js` and `dataLoader.js` split already points this way.
- An internal ledger that matches every partner event to Nexura's transfer records.

- Idempotent webhook handlers, because partners retry callbacks and duplicate payouts are costly.
- A limits engine that mirrors partner limits and adds Nexura's own.
- A KYC step that plugs in the partner's requirements.

Main risks

- Dependence. The partner can raise fees, change terms, or drop Nexura after a compliance review, and it controls the customer experience of the money legs. Using two partners behind the abstraction layer is the standard hedge.
- Regulatory structure. If the arrangement is set up badly, Nexura could still be treated as providing a licensed service. Kenya's VASP Regulations, gazetted 22 July 2026, reach platforms that serve Kenyan users, so the lawyer conversation comes before launch.

Suggested next steps

1. Contact two or three partners and ask: Do you offer a white-label or program model? Who holds customer funds? What are your KYC and per-transaction limits? What are the fees and revenue share? Do you support M-Pesa payouts in Kenya and MTN MoMo payouts in Nigeria? What is your sandbox access process?
2. Book a consultation with a Kenyan fintech lawyer about the licensed-partner structure and the non-custodial flow.
3. Run a sandbox-only transfer end to end with no real money: a test M-Pesa deposit, a testnet swap, and a test MoMo payout.

Sources

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